

Kuro5hin.org

Technology and culture from the trenches

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At first sight, this Web site looks like just another news portal. However, once you read a couple of articles, you will realise that this is anything but. Kuro5hin, or K5, is what can only be described as news from the community, by the community.

K5 has no reporters, and no editor either. Sure, there are trusted members that look after the site in terms of policing the content, but the rules are pretty relaxed—only pornography and extremely offensive material are not allowed.

Where Does The News Come From?

From the K5 community, of course! And all you have to do to join the community is register on the site, wait for a confirmation e-mail, and start posting. Of course, you don't need to do any of that if all you want to do is read the news.

What's So Great About It?

Every registered user is something of an editor. A registered user can post a story, comment on stories, and even vote for stories that have been recently submitted. You can do this by looking for the 'Moderate Submissions' link on the right after signing in. From here, you read stories that have recently been posted, and then rate them.

The screenshot shows the Kuro5hin homepage with a navigation bar at the top containing links like 'Everything', 'Diaries', 'Technology', 'Science', 'Culture', 'Politics', 'Media', 'News', 'Internet', 'Op-Ed', 'Fiction', 'Meta', and 'MLP'. Below the navigation bar, there are several article listings with titles like 'Hot Dog: A Frank Story (MLP)', 'Moby Dick: A Book (Culture)', 'Judicial goblins (Op-Ed)', and 'Google's Autolink: getting to the real issue (Op-Ed)'. On the right side, there is a sidebar with links to 'Moderate Submissions (2/2/4)', 'Review Hidden Comments', 'User Info', 'Your Comments', 'Your Stories', 'Your Diary', 'Your Diary Entry', 'New Diary', 'New Story', 'User Preferences', 'Display Preferences', 'Comment Preferences', and 'Logout raaboo'.

The Kuro5hin homepage is well designed. Everything you might need in order to navigate the site is right there on the homepage

After the predetermined voting time is over, the article is posted on the site, or not posted at all, depending on how much the community likes the story. This ensures that K5's content is always in tune with the interests of the masses, and everyone always gets to read things they find interesting.

Another Slashdot?

Well, yes—sort of. The difference lies in the fact that K5 looks a lot better, and is less of a nightmare to navigate. Moreover, K5 is a lot more than just

The topics are neatly and conveniently arranged along the top of the page, and offer a wide range of interesting reading material—from 'Technology' and 'Science' to 'Politics' and 'Fiction'.

Everything—from articles that teach you a thing or two, to features that tickle your funny bone—can be found under each section. For example, the 'Technology' section currently has articles about one person's experience with laser eye surgery; another write-up explains how a Scottish Mathematician used a chessboard to calculate in binary code; and a story about old, useful technologies that shouldn't have died out and so on.

The site also has 'Diaries', which could be called member blogs. This is your personal section, and you can post whatever you want to. No other member can post articles in your diary, but they can comment. All the members here have teeth, and can bite really hard—so make sure even your diary entries are well thought out and factually correct.

Kuro5hin has the potential of becoming a regularly visited bookmark. Add it to your Favourites folder, and it can provide you with knowledge that you never knew you might need, act as an outlet for your thoughts, and provide you all the reading entertainment in the course of a regular day. From laughs to learning, it's all here!

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The screenshot shows the 'Moderate Submissions' page on Kuro5hin. It features a table with columns for 'Title (topic)', 'Date', and 'Author'. The table lists several stories, including 'How To Get Rich & Famous By Blogging AL Work' and 'Ask K5: Starting an internet radio station'. To the right of the table, there are links for 'Moderate Submissions (2/2/4)', 'Review Hidden Comments', 'User Info', 'Your Comments', 'Your Stories', 'Your Diary', 'Your Diary Entry', 'New Diary', 'New Story', 'User Preferences', 'Display Preferences', 'Comment Preferences', and 'Logout raaboo'. At the bottom of the page, there is a search bar and a link to 'Create account | Sign Up | Login | Search | RSS | You choose the stories!'.

Kuro5hin is a democracy, and every article needs to be voted for before it is posted on the site